Employer Nomination Scheme visa (subclass 186)

Direct Entry stream

This visa lets skilled workers nominated by an employer live and work in Australia permanently.

Personalise this page...

For Applicants For Sponsors

When you have this visa

- Coming to Australia *(#haveThisVisa-index-0)*
- In Australia *(#haveThisVisa-index-1)*
- Leaving Australia *(#haveThisVisa-index-2)*

Coming to Australia

Before you travel

Check your travel documents

You must have:

- a valid visa to enter Australia
- a valid passport or other travel document

At the Border

Completing an Incoming Passenger Card

All people arriving to Australia must complete an Incoming Passenger Card *(https://www.abf.gov.au/entering-and-leaving-australia/crossing-the-border/at-the-border/incoming-passenger-card-(ipc))*. You will be given this card during your flight.

Leaving the airport faster

Ask a question

We have an automated process that uses facial recognition technology and your ePassport. You might be able to leave the airport faster if you use SmartGate *(https://www.abf.gov.au/entering-and-leaving-australia/smartgates/overview)*.

New Zealand passport holders

If an immigration officer processes your clearance at our border, we recommend you tell them:

- you have a permanent Australian visa
- you do not want a Special Category visa (subclass 444)

If you do not tell them, you might be granted the 444 visa. Grant of a subclass 444 visa will override your permanent visa and might affect your eligibility for Australian citizenship.

In Australia

What you can do when you have this visa

This visa lets you:

- stay in Australia indefinitely
- work and study in Australia
- enrol in Australia's public health care scheme, Medicare *(https://www.humanservices.gov.au/individuals/medicare)*
- sponsor eligible relatives to come to Australia
- travel to and from Australia for 5 years
- if eligible, become an Australian citizen *(/citizenship/become-a-citizen)*

Newly arrived residents may have to wait before they can access certain Australian Government payments and benefits *(https://www.humanservices.gov.au/individuals/enablers/newly-arrived-residents-waiting-period)*.

What you must do on this visa (your obligations)

You and your family members must obey all Australian laws.

You agree to begin your employment within 6 months of:

- entering Australia if we granted you the visa outside Australia
- the visa grant date if we granted you the visa in Australia

See how long you can stay

Permanently

Travelling on your visa

From the date we grant this visa, you can travel to and from Australia for up to 5 years.

After that period, you will need a Resident Return (RRV) *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/resident-return-visa-155-157)* visa to re-enter Australia as a permanent resident.

If you leave Australia after the expiry date of your travel facility, without being granted another permanent visa with a valid travel facility, for example a Resident Return (RRV) *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/resident-return-visa-155-157)*, you will

not be able to return to Australia as a permanent resident.

To see when your travel condition ends, use VEVO *(https://online.immi.gov.au/evo/firstParty?actionType=query)*.

Proving you have a visa

To prove you have a visa and show your conditions to someone, use VEVO.

To prove you have been to Australia, request your travel records *(/entering-and-leaving-australia/request-movement-records)*.

Working

When you work in Australia, you are protected by Australian workplace law. See your workplace rights and entitlements *(https://www.fairwork.gov.au/how-we-will-help/templates-and-guides/fact-sheets/rights-and-obligations/visa-holders-and-migrant-workers-workplace-rights-and-entitlements)*.

Bringing family

As an Australian permanent resident, you might be able to sponsor eligible relatives to come to Australia.

To find a visa for your relatives, explore visa options *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-finder/join-family)*.

Becoming an Australian citizen

After a certain time, you might be eligible for Australian citizenship. Find out more about become a citizen *(/citizenship/become-a-citizen)*.

For citizenship purposes, your permanent residency starts on the day:

- we grant the visa, if you were in Australia
- you entered Australia on this visa, if you were outside Australia when we granted it

Leaving Australia

Before you leave

Check your travel documents

You must have a valid passport or other travel document to leave Australia.

Ensure your visa is still valid

Check your conditions and the expiry of your Resident Return visa in VEVO *(/visas/already-have-a-visa/check-visa-details-and-conditions/check-conditions-online)*.

See what you can and must do if your visa has expired or is about to expire *(/visas/visa-about-to-expire)*.

At the Border

Leaving the airport faster

We have an automated process that uses facial recognition technology and your ePassport. You might be able to leave the airport faster if you use SmartGate SmartGate *(https://www.abf.gov.au/entering-and-leaving-australia/smartgates/overview)*.

After you leave

Proving you have been to Australia

To prove you have been to Australia, request your travel records *(/entering-and-leaving-australia/request-movement-records)*.

Last updated:
3 August 2026